

his bittersweet Knoxville: Summer of 1915 for soprano and orchestra is often regarded as one of his masterpieces.

KEY WORKS: Adagio for Strings, 1936; Violin Concerto, 1940; Knoxville: Summer of 1915, 1947; Piano Concerto, 1962

John Cage

1912–1992, AMERICAN

One of the great experimentalists in musical history, Cage was a prominent figure in avant-garde circles in New York from the early 1940s, and by the mid-1960s he had become internationally renowned: he traveled widely, performing his works, and also spread his ideas through writing and lecturing. His music is extremely unorthodox, using unconventional sound sources as well as random and chance processes. In particular, he is famous for his use of the “prepared piano,” in which various small objects (of metal, rubber, or cloth, for example) are placed on or between the strings to alter the instrument’s sound. His most controversial piece is 4'33", in which the performer or performers remain silent for 4 minutes and 33 seconds, the quiet being punctuated